

GW2 In-Game Helper — current state

Tree version 2.3.0.0 · shipping GitHub DLL 2.2.4.11 · 2026-08-18

This pack is a snapshot, not a ranking contest. Numbers are GitHub asset download counts on the latest listed release unless noted. Those counts are not unique users: Nexus auto-update re-downloads the DLL; CEF/catalog zips count first helper opens more than daily actives. Closed-source addons without a public release API are listed without download figures. No single score is used. Hyperbole from earlier canvases in this workspace is not reused.

Sources. Local repo /home/xydroc/Desktop/GW2-InGame-Helper, commit 568b8cd (Keep API Check on ArenaNet only.). GitHub API for Xydroc-IO/GW2-InGame-Helper on 2026-08-18. Normative docs: COMPLIANCE.md, ARCHITECTURE.md, SECURITY.md, ci.yml, tools/ci.sh.

1. What the project is

GW2 In-Game Helper is a Raidcore Nexus ImGui addon. The injected DLL does not host Chromium. It launches an out-of-process helper, `GW2HelperBrowser.exe`, which loads a **private** CEF Stable 150 tree under `addons/GW2-InGame-Helper/cef/` (not `bin64/cef`). Off-screen BGRA frames are copied through PID-scoped shared memory (IPC magic HLI5) and drawn with ImGui via the Nexus swap chain. Pathing world GPS is a separate HLSL ribbon path on the same device. The player copies one DLL; the helper EXE and homepage assets are embedded and extracted on first use.

It is a companion suite: account/API pads, live HTML panels, wiki/site browse, pathing (curated .taco packs + optional PathingLua), economy, events, farming, instances, DPS log ingest (Elite Insights CLI + killproof.me public profiles), notes, overlays, and a Watch path aimed at Linux/Wine. It is not a combat meter, not a d3d11 loader, and not a Present hook.

2. Measured facts (this tree)

Field	Value
AddonVersion.h	2.3.0.0
Latest GitHub DLL tag	2.2.4.11 (2026-08-16) — tree is ahead of shipping
HEAD	568b8cd · 2026-08-17 22:10 –07:00
Repo created	2026-07-19 · stars 2 · open issues 0
License / signature / IPC	MIT · 0x48454C50 (HELP) · HLI5
src/ C++ files	455 .cpp/.h
src/ lines	~92,360
Largest modules	pathing 16,487 · account 16,040 · browse 11,104 · app 8,405
Files > 500 lines	6 (project rule: prefer ≤500 .cpp; BootJs.h 845 and QuickAccessIcon.h 1,428 are blob/embed class)
Files > 400 lines	63
CEF	stock Stable 150.0.14 / Chromium 150.0.7871.129
HTTP budget	ApiBudget default max 6 concurrent WinHTTP calls
API Check (HEAD)	5 ArenaNet canaries, sequential, one TLS session (was a wide probe set)
Working tree	Dirty on master: catalog/API/log-manager and several docs uncommitted

Line counts are physical lines in src/ as of this HEAD, including headers.

3. Shipping vs tree

Players on Nexus auto-update still get **2.2.4.11** (585 GitHub downloads of that DLL as of this pull). The in-tree stamp is already 2.3.0.0. The catalog pre-release tag `gw2-helper-catalog` exists (manifest 20 downloads, names pack 0, icons pack 8, CEF zip

2 on that tag). An older CEF zip on tag 1.0.0.0 has 249 downloads — that is the best public floor for “someone actually extracted the helper runtime,” not a user census.

GitHub asset (this repo)	Size	Downloads
2.2.4.11 GW2-InGame-Helper.dll	18.7 MB	585
2.2.4.10 GW2-InGame-Helper.dll	18.7 MB	120
1.0.0.0 cef-runtime-150-windows64.zip	166.8 MB	249
catalog tag cef-runtime-150-windows64.zip	166.8 MB	2
gw2-helper-catalog.manifest	~KB	20
gw2-helper-catalog.igh (names/recipes)	7.9 MB	0
gw2-helper-icons.igh	126.3 MB	8

Pulled from api.github.com on 2026-08-18. Catalog names pack at 0 means almost nobody on HEAD catalog code has fetched it yet.

4. Process and tests

CI (GitHub Actions, ubuntu-latest) runs `make ci`: version/extract stamps, sites.json schema, CSS downlevel unit test, LogManager + .trl golden parse, WikiIpc layout smoke, JsonView bounds smoke, then a MinGW-w64 smoke build of the DLL + embedded helper. Timeout 30 minutes. Catalog rebuild is a separate scheduled workflow (daily 06:20 UTC) that publishes names/recipes to the pre-release tag and is written not to delete the CEF zip or icons pack.

What CI does not do: MSVC build, in-game load, CEF launch, GPU present, Wine/Proton, API-key integration tests (by policy CI must not need live keys), or a large unit-test corpus. Extra local targets exist (pathing Lua under Wine, CSS). That is a smoke gate, not a product qualification suite.

5. Compliance surface (as documented)

COMPLIANCE.md is treated as normative. Allowed: Nexus APIs, read-only MumbleLink/DataLink for display, SwapChain HLSL GPS (no Present hook, no depth/camera matrix from game memory), local IPC with current-user DACL when ACL APIs work, official api.guildwars2.com, wiki MediaWiki, news feed, public killproof.me profiles, local notes/farming files, GitHub catalog (no keys on the server), curated .taco packs with stated permissions, optional PathingLua (default off), optional Elite Insights CLI with SHA-256, SHA-256 CEF zip, OpenProcess(PROCESS_TERMINATE) only for the helper PID this addon spawned.

Forbidden: game memory R/W, MinHook, MumbleLink for automation, Present / d3d11 wrapper hooks, gameplay SendInput, writing bin64/cef, combat/account automation via BootJs.

Documented exception: Pathing Map Assist may use OS cursor SendInput **only** while the fullscreen world map is open, and only if the player enables MapAssistEnabled (default off). It must not confirm the teleport dialog. A second opt-in exists for click-after-pan. That is still OS input into the game client. Treat it as a ToS-adjacent surface even though it is gated and described.

Other stated limits: CEF builds without H.264/AAC (Twitch Error #4000; YouTube/Twitch go Open Ext). Google/Discord OAuth often fails in embedded CEF. Helper command line currently includes software OSR and `no-sandbox`. Unsigned MinGW binaries may be Defender-flagged. API keys live in local settings.ini (not encrypted).

6. Structure (how the code is laid out)

src/ is split into shared layers (app, ui, api, browse, browser, helper) and feature domains (account, pathing, logs, economy, instances, completion, farming, overlay, events, notes, watch). Includes are flat via multiple -I paths. Dual UI: ImGui pads for workbench tools, generated HTML live panels for Browse. Kernel files (entry, WikiBrowser*, WikiIpc.h) are called out in ARCHITECTURE.md as high blast radius.

The ≤500-line .cpp convention is mostly held. Six files exceed 500 lines; the worst is a 1,428-line QuickAccessIcon.h (embed). Account wallet/unlocks/progress fetch files sit in the 490–587 range. That is manageable but the dual ImGui+HTML+IPC+CEF stack is inherently more moving parts than a single-pad Nexus addon.

7. How the project is doing

For a repo created 2026-07-19, the engineering record is unusually complete: architecture, compliance, security policy, publisher UA, catalog release notes, CI smoke, SHA-256 for CEF and EI, Job Object kill-on-close, PID-scoped IPC, private Chromium tree. Feature breadth is large relative to age (~92k LOC in a month is a high change rate).

The matching risks are also large. One maintainer. Two GitHub stars. Hundreds of DLL downloads, not tens of thousands. Tree version does not match the last shipped tag. Working tree is dirty. Chromium in the addon folder is a real attack surface (no-sandbox, ads/nav policy, BootJs). There is no Authenticode signature. There is no dedicated API cache backend — Live panels hit ArenaNet from the player PC (budget 6). Catalog GitHub Releases is the right split for public names/icons; it is not a warm API. CEF ~167 MB plus a 126 MB icon pack is a first-run cost that Radial/CTK/Boon Table do not have.

Verdict: the codebase is a serious, documented Nexus companion with isolation choices that match its CEF requirement. It is not yet a default install, not yet released as 2.3.0.0, and not a substitute for ArcDPS, Radial, or Commander's Toolkit. Treat 2.3.0.0 as in-progress until a DLL tag exists.